BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #13 · MEDICATIONS AND TREATMENT

"I'll have to take this forever, so I'll never really be well."

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Where it often comes from

Long-term medication for chronic conditions can feel like a life sentence. We equate "well" with "needing nothing," and so we feel permanently broken even when we are doing well.

What Scripture teaches

The apostle Paul prayed three times for his thorn to be removed. Instead, God said, "My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness." People can live full, productive lives while managing a condition. David wrote, "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made." Wellness is not the absence of need but the presence of care, purpose, and peace. Needing daily help is one way to depend daily on God's provision.

> *"But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me"* (2 Corinthians 12:9).

Also see

> "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well" (Psalm 139:14).

> "Bless the LORD, O my soul, and do not forget all His kind deeds— He who forgives all your iniquities and heals all your diseases" (Psalm 103:2–3).

> "I know how to live humbly, and I know how to abound. I am accustomed to any and every situation—to being filled and being hungry, to having plenty and having need. I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength" (Philippians 4:12–13).

> "Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!" (Lamentations 3:22–23).

Common self-statements

- I will always be a patient.
- I will never be normal.
- I am permanently unwell.
- Being on medication means I am sick.
- I cannot ever stop.
- This is a life sentence.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either medication-free and well or sick.
- Fortune telling: Predicting permanent dependence.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling burdened and concluding I am never well.
- Labeling: Calling myself chronically ill.

Challenging questions

- What does “well” mean to me?
- What parts of my life are going well because of this treatment?
- Who do I know who lives fully with a long-term condition?
- How could I see my medication as a daily provision?
- What does Scripture say about grace in weakness?
- What would help me feel more at peace with daily treatment?

Truth summary

> I can live well while managing a condition. Daily care is a provision and a reminder of God’s daily grace, not a sign that I am broken beyond hope.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Sickness
- Thankful
- Weakness
- Trust
- Peace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Weak/Tired
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Already There — Casting Crowns
God’s perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Thrive — Casting Crowns
Life rooted in God includes purposeful growth and joy, not merely surviving or staying busy.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God’s steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ’s resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

My Plan for Replacing "I'll have to take this forever, so I'll never really be well"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'll have to take this forever, so I'll never really be well." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does "well" mean to me?
- ☐ What parts of my life are going well because of this treatment?
- ☐ Who do I know who lives fully with a long-term condition?
- ☐ How could I see my medication as a daily provision?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about grace in weakness?
- ☐ What would help me feel more at peace with daily treatment?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God's grace is sufficient.
- ☐ His power is perfected in weakness.
- ☐ I can live a full life with care.
- ☐ Needing help is not failure.
- ☐ Each day I can thank God for provision.
- ☐ Wellness includes peace.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 2 Corinthians 12:9
  "But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me."
- ☐ Psalm 139:14
  "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."
- ☐ Psalm 103:2–3
  "Bless the LORD, O my soul, and do not forget all His kind deeds— He who forgives all your iniquities and heals all your diseases."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Well in many ways: Each week, note three ways you are doing well.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 2 Corinthians 12:9 becomes: "Sarah can write: "His grace is sufficient for me each day.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Thankful" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Redefine well. Write what a good day looks like.
- [ ] Build a routine. Link medication to a daily habit.
- [ ] Thank God daily. Pair your dose with a short prayer.
- [ ] Talk to your doctor. Ask about long-term outlook and adjustments.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'll have to take this forever, so I'll never really be well": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Well in many ways
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'll have to take this forever, so I'll never really be well.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am tired of daily medicine. Teach me to receive it as Your provision, and help me live fully and gratefully each day. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.